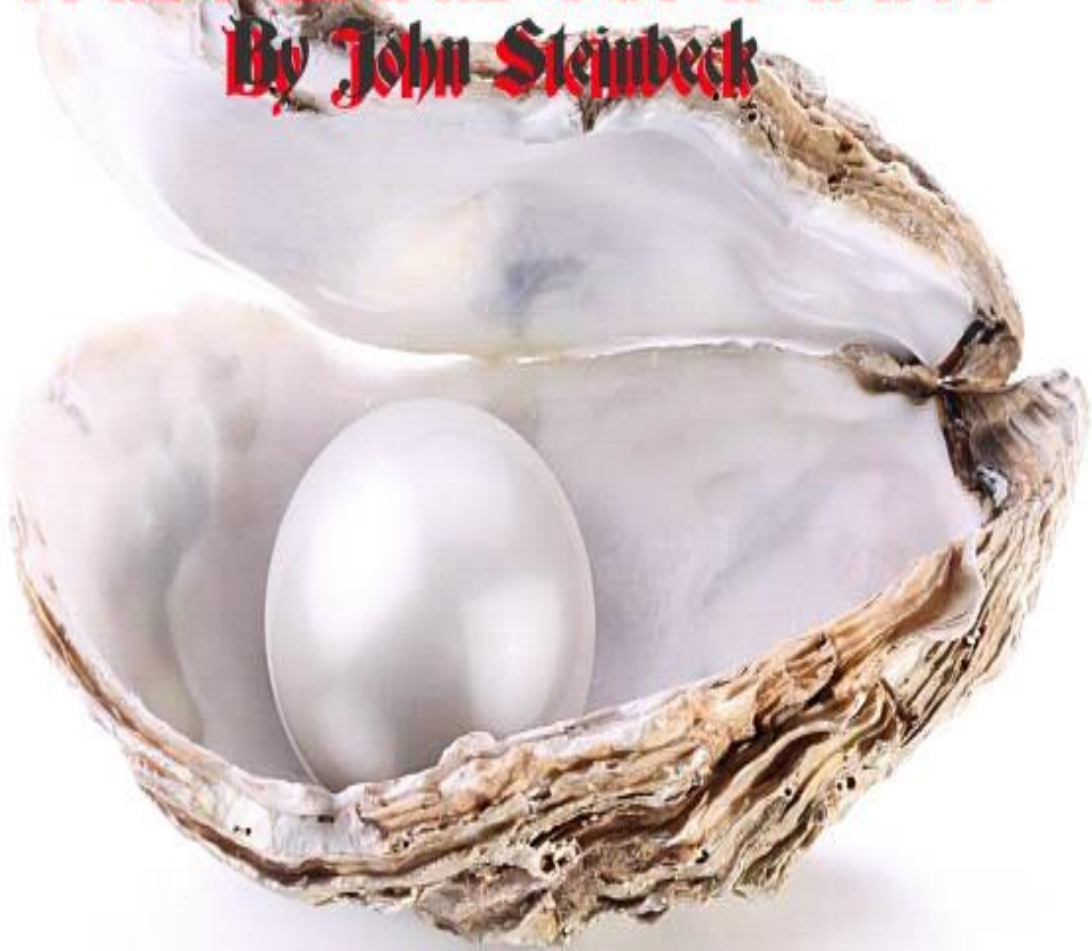


THE PEARL SUMMARY

By John Steinbeck



Evangelist Production

FACTS ABOUT THE PEARL

NARRATOR :

√ The anonymous narrator writes as if telling an old story he or she knows very well.
√ The narrator frequently alludes to the story's ending and freely describes the inner thoughts and feelings of various characters. Rather than tell the story in his own voice, Steinbeck chooses to narrate in a stylized voice recalling that of a storyteller from a society like Kino's, in which stories are handed down from generation to generation, eventually losing their specificities and becoming moral parables, as Steinbeck insinuates in the opening epigraph, by virtue of sheer repetition.

POINT OF VIEW :

√ The narrator uses **third-person, omniscient narration**, meaning he or she not only tells us what various characters think and feel but also provides analysis and commentary on the story. The narrator shifts perspective frequently, focusing most often on Kino but occasionally focusing on other characters such as Juana and the doctor.

TONE :

√ The narrator tells Kino's story to teach a moral lesson, and so treats Kino above all as a cautionary figure. At the same time, however, the narrator seems to see Kino as a sort of tragic hero, and is moved by the human weakness Kino's actions reveal. The narrator often shows a certain respect for Kino's striving to realize his ambitions—even while recognizing the mistakes Kino makes and mourning his ultimate moral downfall.

TENSE · Past

SETTING (TIME) · Unclear, possibly late nineteenth or early twentieth century

SETTING (PLACE) · A Mexican coastal village called La Paz, probably on the Baja Peninsula

PROTAGONIST · Kino

MAJOR CONFLICT ·

√ After finding a magnificent pearl, Kino seeks to sell it to acquire wealth. He wishes for his son's wound to heal, and for his son to obtain an education and become an equal to the European colonists who keep his people in a state of ignorance and poverty. When he tries to sell the pearl, however, Kino quickly meets resistance in the form of other people's greed. Ultimately, his struggle to acquire wealth places him at odds with his family, his culture, and nature, as Kino himself succumbs to greed and violence.

RISING ACTION

√ A scorpion stings Coyotito; Kino discovers a great pearl; Kino's attempts to sell the pearl are unsuccessful, and he is mysteriously attacked; Kino beats Juana for attempting to discard the pearl.

CLIMAX :

√ Kino kills a man who attacks him for his pearl, an event that exposes the tension surrounding this object as a bringer of great evil as well as a chance for salvation.

FALLING ACTION :

√ Kino and Juana flee the village and find themselves chased by trackers; Kino fights with the trackers, not knowing that they have taken Coyotito's cry to be that of a coyote and shot him; Kino and Juana return to the village and throw the pearl back into the sea.

THEMES ·

√ Greed as a destructive force; the roles of fate and agency in shaping human life; colonial society's oppression of native cultures

MOTIFS ·

√ Nature imagery, Kino's songs

SYMBOLS ·

√ The pearl, the scorpion, Kino's canoe

THE PEARL SUMMARY

√ The Novel was first published in 1947 and is about Kino, his wife Juana and son, Coyotito.

√ The son, Coyotito, is stung by a scorpion and Kino has no money for treatment.

√ He hunts for a pearl valuable enough to cover medical bills.

√ He finds a good pearl that ignites jealousy and greed among people of all walks of life.

√ As a result selling a pearl at fair price become difficult. He is therefore unable to pay the medical bills.

√ In an attempt to go to the capital where he can sell the Pearl at a Fair price ,Coyotito is shot by a tracker.

√ Kino believes his wife that the pearl is Evil". He takes is back and throws it into the sea

√ By this time, the Pearl has brought more trouble than wealth. He has lost his Canoe, house and son.

THE GEOGRAPHICAL SETTING

√ The story is set in La Paz Mexico. This is rural (area) fishing village and the larger more developed town of La Paz.

JUSTIFICATION

√ This is evidenced by the simplicity and hardship of the life of fishing village which is constructed to the easier and more comfortable life of the town.

√ Racial problems which evolved from colonial domination.

THE PEARL'S NARRATION

√ The narration is **Third Person Point of View**.

THE PEARL CHAPTER 1 SUMMARY

SETTING:

√ The events in the first chapter are set in the rural area

JUSTIFICATION

√ This is shown by Kino's family and others living in brush houses, keeping roosters and pigs.

PLOT

√ The story starts off with Kino waking in the dark of very early morning.

√ There are roosters and pigs outside, and he lives in a brush house, so we know we're dealing with someplace rural.

√ Kino looks over at Juana, his wife, and his son Coyotito who is sleeping in a hanging box.

√ Juana is awake, as per usual. She never sleeps while Kino is awake.

√ He closes his eyes and listens to the sound (he calls it a "song") of the waves on the beach outside (more setting clues).

√ Actually, he calls it "the Song of the Family," since he knows his people have been hearing it for many generations back (he's a native).

√ Juana gets up and goes to check on their son and makes corncakes on a grinding stone while Kino heads outside and watches the dawn.

√ As a dog curls up near Kino, we are told that "It was a morning like other mornings and yet perfect among mornings."

√ He listens to his wife singing and thinks that too is part of the family song; that it is warm and safe and whole.

√ Kino and his wife have breakfast together without talking; not because there's latent hostility or dissatisfaction; rather, they don't need speech to communicate.

√ And then... something happens. Both Kino and Juana see a scorpion on the hanging cradle and freeze in place.

√ Kino then "hears" another "song," this time "the Song of Evil."
Juana mumbles protective chants under her breath.

√ Kino, meanwhile, decides that action would be better than no action. He moves silently across the room and reaches his hand ever-so-gently toward the scorpion.

√ The scorpion, being a creature of acutely sensitive hearing, raises its very poisonous tail in caution.

√ Then, Coyotito, being a baby who has absolutely no idea what's going on, shakes the cradle, dropping the scorpion inside.

√ Kino grabs the creature and mashes it to a paste, but not before it strikes Coyotito.
Juana takes the screaming baby and tries to suck out the poison; Kino feels helpless.

√ Meanwhile the screaming alerts the neighbors, Juan Tomás and "his fat wife Apolonia" and their four children.

√ Everyone realizes the baby may die.

√ Kino takes a moment to marvel at how strong his wife is, since she can withstand pain and starvation as well (or better) than any man. At the moment, though, she tells him to go get a doctor.

√ The spectators all whisper about how the doctor will never come out here to the poor people and their brush houses, since he attends to the rich folk in the plaster abodes in town.

√ Juana, afraid they are right, decides that they should go to the doctor instead. The spectators follow.

√ The people in town add to the mix, so now the poor trio has a grand following as they make their way to the doctor's house.

√ The beggars in particular watch the scene; they know everything, the narration tells us, since they watch the townspeople going into confession and can read their sins on their faces.

√ The beggars also know how cruel the doctor is, which doesn't bode well for the sick baby.

√ Kino hesitates, reflecting that the doctor's race has been robbing and despising his own race for hundreds of years. He tries to control his anger at such unfair treatment while knocking on the door.

√ When a servant opens the gate, Kino delivers the news "in the old language." The servant, however, refuses to answer in the same dialect.

√ We cut to the doctor, who is appropriately sitting in bed in his gown of "red watered silk that had come from Paris" and drinking from a cup of eggshell china in a silver tray.

√ And he has religious paintings around his room.

√ When the servant comes in with the news of a "little Indian baby" stung by a scorpion, the doctor responds that he's not a veterinary and therefore doesn't cure Indians. Ugh, what a racist.

√ But he does ask if they have any money.

√ The servant goes back to inquire about the cash situation; Kino pulls out eight small, misshapen pearls that are "nearly valueless."

√ The servant takes the pearls, goes inside, returns and gives them back, and reports that the doctor is out, which isn't even a good lie.

√ The crowd feels the wave of shame passing over Kino and leaves; Kino stands at the gate long after until, in anger, he strikes it with his fist and splits his knuckles open.

CHARACTER ANALYSIS IN CHAPTER (I)

(1) KINO

Violent Temper

√ He reacts violently to the scorpion which bites the son.

√ When the doctor refuses to treat Coyotito he gets angry and punches the gates.

Loving

√ He loves his wife and child

Superstitious

√ Believes in the songs of the family and evil

(2) JUANA

Caring and Dutiful

√ She works up in the morning and takes care of Kino and child.

Religious and Pragmatic

√ When Coyotito is attacked by Scorpion she says prayers for protection and calls for the doctor.

(3) DOCTOR

Racists

√ He does not want to treat Indians. To him Indians are animals.

Selfish

√ He does not come out to hear Kino's problem.

Greedy / Money Hungry

√ He wants to help Kino on one condition, if he has enough money.

THE PEARL CHAPTER 2 SUMMARY

SETTING

√ The events happen in two near the beach of an estuary at the rural area

JUSTIFICATION

√ The presence of Canoe that are seen coming from Nayarit and the presence of wild pigs and dogs roaming the beach looking for food.

PLOT

√ Now that we've met the people and started the storyline, Steinbeck figures he'll tell us where all this is taking place.

√ The town is located on the beach of an estuary; canoes can be seen coming in from Nayarit, which means we're in Mexico and probably near the tip of the Baja Peninsula.

√ Once again we see the area isn't too densely populated, since wild pigs and dogs roam the beach looking for food.

√ It's also very dreamlike, the narration tells us explicitly. (Just picture the "copper haze" over the water and the blinding reflection of the sun—this, we are told, is why the townspeople feel there is no certainty in seeing.)

√ Kino and Juana make their way with Coyotito down to Kino's canoe, which is "the one thing of value he owned in the world." It's old and once belonged to Kino's grandfather.

√ Meanwhile, Coyotito is getting worse; the swelling from the sting has moved up from his shoulder and toward his face. Juana puts a poultice of seaweed over the wound, which is "probably better than the doctor could have done."

- √ Juana prays silently that Kino will find a pearl in the water big enough to pay a doctor.
- √ Once in the canoe, Kino paddles them out amongst the other pearlers already in the water.
- √ The oyster bed below them is littered with cracked, opened shells, the pearls of which once made the King of Spain wealthy.
- √ Pearls, we are told, are made when a grain of sand irritates the inside of the oyster; the oyster simply coats the foreign body with layer after layer, which over time builds up a pearl. Finding one is an accident, simply good luck from God.
- √ Kino dives to the bottom with the help of a heavy rock. Once at the water's bottom, he fills a basket with unopened oysters and while he works hears another song, this time "The Song of the Pearl That Might Be."
- √ Kino is skilled and can stay under water for two minutes, expertly choosing the best oysters.
- √ And then... he sees one huge oyster, slightly opened, alone on an overhang. The oyster is opened ever-so-slightly, and Kino sees something gleam inside it.
- √ Grabbing this shell and his basket, Kino kicks for the surface.
- √ Juana senses his excitement and so looks away; expecting too much might drive away the luck.
- √ Kino doesn't want to start with the big Papa Bear Oyster, but after opening one pithy pair of shells with his knife he looks at it again.
- √ Now he starts to doubt; maybe he only saw the gleam of the shell's iridescent interior; after all, "in this gulf of uncertain light there were more illusions than realities."
- √ Juana tells Kino, in her own gentle way, to open the big oyster already.
- √ Kino does, and in case the cover of your book or the blurb on the back hasn't already informed you, inside is the greatest pearl ever, the supermodel of all pearls, the big cheese, the pearl we've all been waiting for. It's as big as a sea-gull's egg.
- √ Juana draws Kino's attention to Coyotito; the swelling has gone down and it looks like the poison is leaving his body.
- √ Kino howls emotionally, which leads to all the other canoers paddling over to his boat. Probably not the greatest move when you've got the world's most valuable pearl in your hand.

CHARACTER ANALYSIS IN CHAPTER (II)

(1) KINO

Responsible

√ He tries to source a pearl that can be sold for his son's treatment

Courageous and Strong

√ He is able to gather Oyster under water for a full two minutes.

Overexcited / Extravert

√ Shows his excitement upon discovering the valuable Pearl. This has attracted other to his boat.

Skillful

√ He is well known expert, h stays and at f t full minutes looking f the best Oyster.

(2) JUANA**Creative**

√ Puts poultice of sea weed over the wound and the swelling has gone down.

Religious

√ Prays silently for Kino's success in the ocean.

Calm

√ When Kino gets the valuable pearl deliberately looks away because she holds belief that much expectation drives lucky away.

THE PEARL CHAPTER 3 SUMMARY**SETTING**

√ The chapter has two settings, rural and urban.

JUSTIFICATION

√ It is rural area because of the presence of Kino's brush house.

√ It is in urban area because of the presence of doctor, the town, Pearl year and shopkeeper.

PLOT

√ News about Kino's pearl travels fast across town.

√ Unfortunately, everyone is self-serving: the priest hears about the pearl and thinks about repairs needed for the church, the shopkeepers think about the clothes they could sell to Kino, etc.

√ Then the doctor realizes Kino was the guy from earlier, and he thinks about Paris and fine dining.

√ Then we cut to the pearl-buying offices. This is where all the "agents" sit around and haggle a man into taking the lowest possible prices for his pearls.

√ Even more depressing, these miserable scrooges are only buying the pearls on behalf of other (richer) folk.

√ Kino, we are told, becomes everyone's enemy. Each person sees what the pearl could do for him, and Kino becomes the only man standing in their way.

√ But Kino and Juana are happily oblivious. They sit at home with Kino's brother Juan and his wife Apolonia; Kino talks about what he will do once he becomes a rich man.

√ He decides he wants to get married to his wife—officially and in the church, now that they can pay for it. He looks into the pearl and sees a vision of them at the altar, dressed all spiffy.

√ Then he says he wants a rifle.

√ Kino continues: his son Coyotito will go to school.

√ But then he gets scared at his own talking, seeming to doubt the real capabilities of this magical pearl.

√ The priest comes to visit, but he's super-condescending because he considers the natives to be children.

√ He flatters Kino and puts in his two cents about how they should donate money to the church.

√ Juana receives his words kindly, and the priest leaves.

√ Kino is distracted by the evil song, which is competing with the song of the pearl.

√ Once all the spectators have gone back to their homes for the night, Kino sits around and realizes that many are plotting against him.

√ He decides to counter-plot.

√ While he's busy doing that, two men with lanterns approach his home: the doctor and his servant.

√ The doctor says he was out earlier, but now he's come to look at the baby.

√ Kino tells him the baby is better, but the doctor counters that sometimes scorpion stings seem to get better when really they're getting worse.

√ The doctor takes a look at Coyotito and is all, "Hmm! Hurmph! Well!" and says the poison is holed-up on the inside with blueprints and planning a second attack just as soon as it gets its beauty rest.

√ He then gives Coyotito a mysterious capsule, which we speculate contains poison.

- √ The doctor goes outside, and Kino wraps up and hides the pearl. Good call, buddy.
- √ Sure enough, the baby gets sick. Juana says "the doctor knew," but Kino is suspicious, mostly because of the evil song he's hearing.
- √ The doctor then gives Coyotito something else (antidote), packs up his bags, and asks when Kino will be able to pay the bill.
- √ Kino is all, "As soon as I sell my pearl," and the doctor is all, "Ooh, you have a pearl? Really? Tell me more about this mysterious object that, before this very moment, I have not heard mention of whatsoever. Also, I'll "hold" it for you in my "safe."
- √ Kino passes on the offer, but not-so-intelligently lets his eyes travel to the place in the hut where the pearl is hidden.
- √ Everyone leaves. Kino hears more evil music, so he moves the pearl to a hole he's dug under his sleeping mat.
Juana asks who he is afraid of, and Kino answers, "Everyone."
- √ They all go to sleep until Kino awakens with the song of evil pulsing through him.
- √ What follows is a scuffle in the dark with at least one intruder: Kino gets smashed on the head, but chases off the bad guy.
- √ As Juana nurses his injury, she declares that the pearl is a sin, that it's evil, and that it will destroy them if they don't throw it back into the ocean.
- √ Kino, who is busy oscillating between fear and rage, doesn't listen.
- √ The next morning, Kino digs up the pearl and stares at its beauty while listening to its song. He feels hopeful again—today is the day he will sell the pearl.

CHARACTER ANALYSIS IN CHAPTER (III)

(1) PRIEST

Selfish

- √ Thinks of his church and not the life of Kino and his family.

Greedy

- √ He becomes ambitious with Kino's money after he will sell the Pearl.

(2) SHOPKEEPER

Selfish

√ He thinks of clothes he will sell to Kino and the money he may get.

Greedy:

√ He thinks of doing better for himself.

(3) DOCTOR:**Wicked**

√ give baby poison capsule

Pretentious

√ Pretends that he has been away when Kino came to his house

Greedy

√ He wants to assist Kino after hearing that he will be rich because of his pearl

(4) PEARL BUYERS**Cheats**

√ They would like to buy the pearl at the lowest price.

Selfish

√ Wants to buy the Pearl at the lowest price at the expense of the poor Kino.

(5) JUANA**Caring**

√ Nurses Kino's injury.

Cautious and sensitive

√ Warns Kino the effects of the pearl to their family.

(6) KINO**Cautious/ Protective**

√ Hides the pearl

Suspicious

√ sees everyone as his enemy

Optimistic

√ Hopes the pearl shall make the family rich

Open

√ he tells people what he can do if he gets rich

Revengeful

√ Count plots against his enemies.

THE PEARL CHAPTER 4 SUMMARY**SETTING**

√ The event take place in urban area

JUSTIFICATION

√ The mentioning of the town called La Paz Baja peninsula in Mexico.

PLOT

√ The name of the town is La Paz, which is indeed on the Baja Peninsula in Mexico.

√ La Paz is a gossip-ridden town. As such, everyone and their mother knows that Kino is going to sell his pearl today.

√ It used to be, we are told, that the pearl buyers would try to outbid one another to buy a pearl. But this form of self-regulating, free-market capitalism proved too costly for the merchants; so now they collude and agree on a price beforehand that is far below the pearl's actual value.

√ None of the pearl-divers are even going out diving today since there's too much excitement to be had on land (namely, watching Kino sell his pearl).

√ All the spectators stand around and talk about the things they would do if they had found the pearl, like buy world peace.

√ Juana dresses herself and Coyotito in their finest clothes (from her marriage and his baptism), and she and Kino lead the procession into town.

√ Juan cautions his brother not to get cheated by the pearl-buyers.

√ He then reminds Kino of a story their father told them when they were young: the locals, realizing that the agents wouldn't give them fair prices, pooled their pearls and sent them all with one man to the capital, to sell in a larger and presumably more just market. The man disappeared. They tried it again, same deal. So they were stuck getting cheated by the resident pearl-buyers.

√ Kino knows that trying to sell the pearls elsewhere went against religion; apparently the priests in the area have convinced them that every man has a station in life, and trying to move away from that station is evil.

√ At the agents' offices, a man sits waiting at a desk, dressed for business and mechanically twirling a coin in between the knuckles of his fingers.

√ When Kino arrives and declares he has a pearl to sell, the buyer continues to twirl the coin in his hand—but hidden under the desk.

√ Kino slowly unwraps the pearl and looks the buyer's eyes for a reaction, but he sees none.

√ The coin, however, slips from the buyer's hand and falls silently into his lap.

√ The buyer pokes at the pearl and calls it "clumsy" for being too large.

√ Finally, he offers a thousand pesos. Kino counters that it's worth fifty thousand.

√ The dealer is fearful, but he hides it and tells Kino to go ask the other dealers independently (since they're all working together to keep the offers very low).

√ The next guy offers six hundred, so Kino snatches his pearl back and declares he will go sell it in the capital.

√ As he storms out, one of the dealers calls that he could do fifteen hundred pesos, but Kino is having none of it.

√ The dealers share a collective, "Drat!" and go back to playing with their coins. The crowd, meanwhile, wonders if maybe Kino is being greedy. After all, fifteen hundred pesos is a lot of money for a poor man, they say.

√ Kino goes home, buries the pearl, and feels afraid. He's hesitant to take the journey to the capital because he's never been away from home before, and he doesn't know anything about different lands.

√ His brother Juan comes to visit. Kino declares the buyers are cheats, and Juan affirms that they have been cheated all their lives. He is worried for Kino's safety, and leaves him with "Go with God."

√ Kino then sits around and worries for a bit. Juana knows there's nothing she can do but comfort him with her presence.

√ She then fights the song of evil with the song of family.

√ As the night grows darker, Kino gets more and more paranoid that something is outside waiting to attack. He goes to the doorway, and when Juana follows she finds him on the ground bleeding from the head—there is a long gash from his ear to his chin.

- √ Once again, Juana tells her husband that the pearl is evil and they must get rid of it.
- √ He argues and concludes with (no joke): "Believe me, I am a man."
- √ Kino plans for them to leave tomorrow in their canoe for the capital.
- √ Then they go to sleep.

CHARACTER ANALYSIS IN CHAPTER (IV)

(1) PEARL BUYERS

Cheats

- √ They offer Kino lowest price

Cooperative / United

- √ They meet in advance and agree on a price that is far below the actual price

Greedy

- √ Wants to make more profits at the expense of the poor.

(2) PEARL DIVERS

Narrow minded

- √ They have not gone to work just because they want to see Kino selling his pearl.

(3) KINO

Optimistic

- √ He hopes to sell his pearl at the fair price to meet his dreams

Superstitious

- √ Holds the belief that selling the pearl elsewhere is against religion
- √ He believes that everyone is against him

Resolute/ consistent

- √ He stand on his belief and his plan; he does not allow to sell his pearl at lowest price

Courageous

- √ Although he has been attacked, he continues with his plan of selling the Pearl to the town.

(4) JUAN TOMAS

Mindful /cautions

√ He cautions/reminds Kino not to be cheated by the pearl buyers.

Sensitive

√ Sensed danger on Kino. He feels that Kino has no safety because of his pearl.

Loving

√ He cautions his brother not to get cheated by the pearl buyers

(5) JUANA**Understanding**

√ She cares more about Kino and comforts him with her presence

√ When Kino gets attached she nurses him

Superstitious

√ She believe that the pearl is evil

THE PEARL CHAPTER 5 SUMMARY**SETTING:**

√ The events take place in rural area at night.

JUSTIFICATION

√ The presence of the word village and the beach.

PLOT

√ Kino opens his eyes in the darkness to see Juana gliding about like a shadow. He watches her silently leave their hut and follows her out to the beach in a rage.

√ Kino manages to stop her just as she is about to throw the pearl into the water. He wrestles it back, strikes her in the face, and kicks her once she's fallen to the ground.

√ Juana is terrified and, looking at Kino, knows that he is capable of murder.

√ As Kino makes his way back to the hut, a figure attacks him. He stabs the figure with his knife while the pearl is knocked onto the ground.

√ Juana, meanwhile, isn't angry at her husband. She knows he is a man, which means he is "half insane and half god," which means he will struggle against mountains and oceans even though he's out of his weight division, so to speak.

- √ Her job, she knows, is to be a woman, which means "reason," "caution," and "preservation."
- √ Juana picks herself up off the ground and retrieves the pearl. Holding it in her hands, she wonders whether she should go back and finish the job (i.e., throw it back into the ocean).
- √ But then she sees two figures in the darkness, Kino, moving sluggishly, and a second man who is bleeding from the throat.
- √ Then she decides it would be useless to throw the pearl away; now that Kino has killed a man, she can never retrieve the peace they all had before the pearl came into their lives.
- √ When the couple makes it back home, Kino rants about how he lost the pearl until Juana tells him she retrieved it and he should stop whining because they need to skip town before he's convicted of murder.
- √ When they get to the canoe, he sees that someone has knocked a hole in the bottom. Kino is in a rage; this is worse than killing a man, he thinks, because a boat cannot heal or protect itself.
- √ Kino becomes an animal; his only thoughts are for survival and protection.
- √ He runs back to his house only to see that someone has lit it on fire.
- √ He takes Juana and Coyotito and runs to his brother's nearby house, where Apolonia is busy grieving, thinking they're dead.
- √ She stops grieving.
- √ Because Juan is the older brother, he takes authority; he tells Kino that the pearl is evil and that he will hide him for the day (dawn is breaking) before his (Kino's) journey the next evening to the North.
- √ The next night, after darkness has fallen, Juan asks if Kino is willing to destroy the pearl.
- √ Kino declares that the pearl has become his soul.

CHARACTER ANALYSIS IN CHAPTER (V)

(1) KINO

Short tempered

- √ The way had handled his wife when she is about to throw the Pearl back into the ocean.

Strong

- √ He defeats two men intending to attack him.

Stubborn

√ He does not listen his brother and wife to throw the Pearl back into the ocean.

(2) JUANA**Forgiving**

√ She does not divorce her husband Kino for beating her.

Cautious

√ Cautious her husband to escape to the capital before he convicted of murder.

(3) APOLONIA**Loving**

√ She sympathizes with Kino and here house because of the burning of their house.

Sympathetic

√ She grieves of the burning of the house of Kino and Juana.

(4) JUAN**Cautious**

√ Cautions Kino to leave to the North the following evening for his family to be protected because the pearl they possess is evil.

Sympathetic

√ He sympathizes with Kino and his family in every unfortunate situation.

THE PEARL CHAPTER 6 SUMMARY**SETTING:**

√ The events taken in urban area and on the way to the North towards Lereto, another town on Baja Peninsula

JUSTIFICATION

√ The presence of the word town and capital

PLOT

√ Kino and Juana travel with Coyotito north toward Lareto (another town on the Baja Peninsula).

√ We learn some more insight into Kino: he gets in touch with his ancestors while watching the stars and the wilderness.

√ They find the road, and Kino travels with the music of the pearl and the music of family intermingling in his mind.

√ When they stop to hide and rest on the side of the road during daylight, he brushes away their footprints.

√ Kino gives Juana a bunch of advice on what kind of trees to avoid and what is bad luck, etc. She already knows all of this, but she humors him anyway.

√ Juana suggests that maybe the dealers were right, maybe the pearl is valueless and this has all "been an illusion."

√ Kino counters that, if this were true, everyone wouldn't be trying to steal it.

√ He then decides to comfort himself by looking into the pearl and imagining all the things he can buy with his wealth. He speaks of a rifle, but all he can see is the nameless, murdered man on the ground. He speaks of getting married in a church, but all he can see in the reflection of the pearl is Juana lying beaten on the ground.

√ The music of the pearl grows sinister, so Kino puts it back in his pocket.

√ They go to sleep (it's still daylight) and Kino wakes from a horrible nightmare, sensing that something is wrong. He tells his wife to keep Coyotito quiet.

√ Through the bushes he watches a group of trackers go by. These are dangerous men with sharp senses—so it's bad news for any folk that might be hiding in the underbrush with the world's most valuable pearl.

√ Kino sneaks to the edge of the road, draws his knife and gets ready to attack if he needs to.

√ Coyotito starts making noises, so Juana suckles him to keep him quiet.

√ Nervous and preparing for flight, Kino hurries back to Juana. He tells her they are trackers and wonders whether he should give up himself to save his family.

√ But then he declares they will go try to hide themselves in the mountains. Panicked, he doesn't even bother to hide their tracks as they move.

√ The terrain as they travel to higher ground is desert, with cacti and little water and broken rock underfoot.

√ Kino hears the music of evil again.

√ When they get higher, they stop to rest. Kino looks behind him but can't see any sign of the trackers.

- √ Kino decides that Juana and Coyotito should hide while he goes North to sell the pearl.
- √ But Juana resolutely refuses. So that's that. They keep moving up the mountains, but this time they're not as panicked.
- √ Kino leaves decoy footprints as they go so as to lead the trackers off in the wrong direction.
- √ At last, Kino and Juana find water in pool fed by a little stream.
- √ Everything is fantastic until Kino looks down the slope and sees the trackers approaching; he judges that they will get to the pool by evening.
- √ Spotting some shallow caves, Kino decides they should hide out. He warns Juana that she must not let Coyotito cry out.
- √ That night, the trackers camp out by the pool and build a fire. Leaving Juana in the cave with the baby, Kino decides to be confrontational. He takes off his white clothes, since his dark skin is better camouflage.
- √ As she watches her husband go, Juana whispers prayers and incantations of protection.
- √ Kino slides toward the trackers in the darkness, listening to the Song of the Family and the music of the enemy.
- √ Just when he is about to attack, the moon rises. There's too much light, so Kino holds himself back.
- √ Then... Coyotito cries out. The trackers think it is just a coyote with her pups, and one of them declares that, if it is, this ought to silence him.
- √ He then raises his gun in the direction of Juana and Coyotito; Kino leaps up and stabs his knife into the man's neck just as the gun goes off.
- √ Kino goes nuts on the three men, managing to stab two, steal the rifle, and shoot the other man between the eyes.
- √ Just as he's reveling in his victory, though, he hears "the cry of death" coming from the cave.
- √ There's a break in the page and, while we don't start a new chapter, we definitely pull out of this story. The narration begins to speak of the town of La Paz, and how everyone in it remembers the return of the family.
- √ Then we get to see the return. Kino and Juana return side-by-side, which is unusual since she usually follows behind him. (Because she's a woman.)
- √ Kino carries a rifle, and Juana carries a limp, unmoving, bloody bundle in her shawl.

√ According to what the villagers say, the couple seems "removed from human experience." They had experienced pain and are now protected by some sort of magic.

√ Kino, meanwhile, hears the "Song of the Family," which has become for him a battle cry.

√ Kino walks to the water's edge, past his destroyed canoe. He takes out the pearl and looks into it, and sees in it evil faces. He sees one of the dead trackers and Coyotito's body "with the top of his head shot away."

√ The pearl now looks horrible and ugly to him, like a cancerous growth. The pearl's music is now distorted, different than before.

√ He tries to hand it over to Juana, but she says, "No, you."
So Kino flings the pearl with all his might into the ocean. It falls to the bottom and is covered by a cloud of sand.

√ The music of the pearl disappears.

CHARACTER ANALYSIS IN CHAPTER (VI)

(1) KINO

Suspicious

√ He brushes away their foot prints so he cannot be traced by people.

Courageous and strong

√ Manages to kill the trackers

Optimistic

√ Believes that he will do a lot when he sells his pearl

(2) JUANA

Decisive

√ She does not allow to remain behind as Kino goes alone to sell a Pearl in the city

Superstitious

√ She refuses to handle a pearl when Kino gives her, she believes that it is evil.

Caring and Loving

√ She carries her dead baby back home

(3) TRACKERS

Greedy

√ Attacks Kino because of the pearl he wants to sell in town

Evil Minded

√ Want to eliminate Kino and his family because of the Pearl

MAJOR THEMES IN THE PEARL**(1) OBSESSION**

√ Kino dives for pearls in attempt to find one with great value

√ He would like to pay the doctor for Coyotito's treatment after being stung by a Scorpion. He gets one valuable Pearl.

√ Kino considers the pearl as a fulfillment of his dreams for the family. He will acquire new clothes, conduct church wedding with his wife Juana, buy a riffle for himself and pay education expenses for Coyotito.

√ Kino kills a ma when he is attacked in self-defense.

√ Kino savagely beats his wife up when she tries to throw Pearl back into the sea.

√ Kino clings to the pearl until their baby dies. His house is burned, Canoe destroyed.

√ Kino claims that the pearl has become his soul.

√ On the way to the capital he kills three men following them for the pearl.

(2) GREED

√ The news of Kino's pearl has stirred up evil intention from various people. Greed is evil and has infected both the rich and the poor.

√ The doctors, merchants, priest and beggars all think of the pearl in monetary terms.

√ Greed makes people in town to conduct acts of violence against Kino is attempting to still the pearl. Blood is shed.

(3) CORRUPTION

√ Corruption has fueled greed. Thus is seen in the lives of individuals and the society at large.

√ The doctor is corrupted by his love of money and fine possession in silk robe. He sits in his beautiful house sipping chocolate from a China cup while he refuses to treat Coyotito, who has been stung by a scorpion. He does this because the baby is an Indian and he says he not a veterinary. He later gives a hand to Kino's pearl.

(4) RELIGION

√ Religion is portrayed negatively in the Novel. The priest who is supposed to be a strong pillar and a role model seems corrupt and self-serving.

√ Kino's life has fallen apart even though he is a religious man. Juana has been offering a protection prayer but little seems to have taken place.

√ Based on this religion in the story is not something to be trusted and counted on. It leads to disappointment.

(5) PRICE OF WISDOM

√ Juana seems to have the understanding of the impact of clinging to the pearl. She says "It will destroy us all" and even our son. This has come to pass because their house is burnt, Kino's canoe smashed and their son Coyotito shot dead.

√ Juana Tomas too tries to save them from destruction. He says "there is a devil in the pearl". He advices Kino to sell it or throw it back into the ocean in order to pass on the devil.

√ Juan believes that if Kino sells the Pearl he will buy a peace for himself but Kino refuses. He clings to it.

√ Kino beat his wife for trying to throw the pearl back into the ocean. In the end Kino has come to believe that both Juana and Juan were right.

√ Kino personally returns the pearl to the sea after the death of his son, his house burnt and Canoe smashed. This is a terrible price to pay for Kino's acquiring wisdom.

(6) IMPORTANCE OF THE FAMILY

√ The family is indicated as the only institution where one can find warmth. When Kino seems to be troubled he finds warmth from his wife Juana.

√ Juana gives warmth to Kino in the following ways: by her presence to him, she nurses Kino's wound when he gets attached.

√ Kino says when he gets rich, will marry his wife Juan through the church. All this because he is satisfied.

√ Kino is accompanied by his family to the market to sell the pearl with high expectations.

√ Juana and Coyotito seem to enjoy Kino's protection as family head.

√ Juana, Kino's brother and his wife sympathizes what Kino pass through. He advices Kino that he should not be cheated by the pearl buyers, when Kino's house is burnt, he offers him accommodation.

√ The family song Kino hears also symbolizes the significance of the family. All in all Kino enjoys the warmth and this shows that the family is the very important institution ever.

(7) WEALTH

√ The story shows that wealth has both advantages and disadvantages. He goodness is that it brings joy and one is able to meet needs and fulfill family needs (obligations) Kino feels that once he gets rich will be able to marry his wife through church and send his son to school.

√ On the other hand wealth has challenges, for example; Kino has become center of attraction. Various people plot to attack him and his family and get away with the pearl. Almost everybody wants to cheat Kino in order to get his pearl.

√ In the end his house is burnt to ashes, Canoe smashed and his son Coyotito is shot dead all because of the Pearl.

√ Wealth brings both happiness and insecurity. To show insecurity perhaps that's why Kino says one of the item he will buy when he get rich is a rifle.

(8) GOOD VERSUS EVIL

√ Family is good. It brings warmth and comfort one needs in difficult times.

√ Greed is evil. It makes people envious and filled with self-serving spirit. For example the priest who thinks of church repair and the doctor who needs Paris and furniture.

√ Love is good. It brings consolation of the mind is the best medicine in hard times. For instance Kino beats up his wife because of the pearl, but in the end they reconcile because of the love.

(9) GENDER

√ Kino by virtue of being the man he becomes family head and Jun respects all decisions made by Kino whether good or bad. The same applies to Juan over Apolonia.

√ Kino is ultimate speaker of the family and everyone should bow down to him.

(10) PREMITIVE

√ The pearl has changed the man form civilized and to primitive one. He is scared and a protective beast. He declares that everyone is his enemy and is afraid of everyone.

√ When Kino's wife takes the pearl without his knowledge to throw it back into the sea (ocean) he savagely beast her up.

- √ Kino goes further by killing a man who wants to attack him for his pearl. He cuts him on the throat.
 - √ Finally Kino kills the trackers just to protect his pearl.
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MORAL LESSONS IN THE PEARL

(1) MONEY CANT BUY HAPPINESS

" Before finding the "Pearl of the World," Kino's family is poor but content. Their basic needs (food, shelter) are met. Kino and Juana have a network of friends upon whom they can rely.

√ The discovery of the gem changes all that; suddenly, Kino is no longer satisfied with having base needs fulfilled. He becomes more and more obsessed with the idea of how wealth can change their lives, thinking money will be able to ensure a better life for his family

√ But the pearl has insidious effects. It separates Kino from his people. When Juana asks, "Who do you fear?"

√ Kino searched for a true answer, and at last he said, "Everyone. " And he could feel a shell of hardness drawing over him.

√ Juana sees how the pearl is destroying her husband's integrity. She begs him to rid them of the supposed treasure; she foresees the horrific consequences: "It will destroy us," she cried. "Even our son."

√ Juana is right. It will take the death of Coyotito to shake Kino out of his money-tinged reverie. Steinbeck's moral seems to be that money, instead of happiness, frequently purchases misery.

(2) THE DANGER OF GREED

√ This is of course primarily shown in the way that the pearl transforms Kino throughout the novel as he seeks to improve his own life through selling the pearl.

√ Consider how Kino is presented at the beginning of the novel. He is shown to be a contented father, enjoying good relationships with his wife and son. However, the possession of the pearl changes all of this, corrupting his innocence and contentment and transforms him into someone who is willing to kill others brutally to safeguard his pearl.

√ The greed that dominates Kino is shown to dehumanise him, making him more like an animal than a human, leading him to beat his wife and also indirectly leading to his son's death. Note how he responds to his wife when she tries to get rid of the pearl:

√ Kino looked down at her and his teeth were bared. He hissed at her like a snake, and Juana stared at him with wide unfrightened eyes, like a sheep before the butcher.

Kino is described as being more like an animal, with his teeth "bared" and the simile comparing him to a snake. Even though it is his wife in front of him, Juana is described as being "like a sheep before the butcher."

√ Greed has transformed Kino to such an extent that he would even kill his wife to preserve the pearl, and is shown to be losing his humanity.

√ The overwhelming message of this excellent story is that greed corrupts and destroys, and if we let it have dominion over our lives, as Kino did, we risk losing our very selves.

(3) FAMILY UNITY IS VERY IMPORTANT

Family unity is portrayed as an important aspect in this novel. Strong family values are shown.

√ Kino and his family struggle through various difficulties together. Although the challenges are great, they stay united as love, support, respect and hope keep them going.

√ Kino loses all hope because he thinks that he has lost the pearl after being attacked by the intruder whom he later kills. Juana gives Kino strength and makes him feel like a man again.

√ The family runs away together in the darkness after Kino kills the attacker and their house is burnt down. Although they are in a great deal of trouble, they are together as a family and Kino finds comfort in being a part of his family.

(4) WE MUST HELP EACH OTHER IN TIMES OF DIFFICULTIES

√ Juan Tomas, Kino's Brother always helps him in times of difficulties in this chapter.

√ Juan Tomas is willing to help Kino by hiding him in his house. He also lies about Kino's whereabouts to save him from the attackers. Apolonia helps to pack some food for Kino's journey.

(5) WE SHOULD NOT BE OBSESSED WITH OBJECTS OF A MATERIAL NATURE

√ When one becomes totally preoccupied with an object, one tends to regard the object as the most important thing in his or her life and neglects everything else, even the family.

√ Even Kino himself is obsessed with the pearl. Although he plans to use it to improve himself and his family's situation, he becomes obsessed with it and turns violent, even against Juana.

√ In this chapter, Kino's anger turns to rage when he discovers that Juana is about to throw the pearl away. He becomes a changed person – he is filled with anger, turning animal-like and "hissed at her like a snake". He beats her up and kicks her. Kino even kills his attacker to prevent the pearl from getting away from him.

√ This shows that he is obsessed with the pearl and he would rather kill than give up the pearl.

(6) WE MUST HONOUR AND RESPECT A PERSON'S CULTURE AND THE WAY OF LIFE

✓ For Kino and the pearl fishers, the canoe is their means of survival – to catch fish and to go pearl –fishing.

✓ In this chapter, when Kino finds his canoe is damaged, he feels great sorrow and rage that someone could do such a thing.

✓ The act of damaging the canoe is so serious for Kino and his people that it is like someone committing a murder.

✓ It is also because of this same respect that Kino does not even consider stealing another canoe to escape.

(7) WE MUST BE PROTECTIVE OVER OUR LOVED ONES.

✓ In Chapter 5, Juan Tomas is being protective over his brother Kino and his family.

✓ Juan Tomas provides Kino and his family shelter before he runs away.

✓ Juan Tomas tells Kino to avoid the coast as the men from the town are looking for him there.

✓ Juan Tomas also advises Kino on what he should have done – sold the pearl to avoid the attacks.

HOWEVER THE LESSON OF THE PEARL MIGHT BE STATED, THE STORY SHOWS CLEARLY THAT KINO'S "PEARL OF THE WORLD" DESTROYS THE PEACE, HARMONY, AND GOODNESS OF HIS OWN WORLD.

(Good Luck)

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